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STAFF MEMO

Date: March 20th, 2026

To: Board of Education

From: Dr. Jon Franco, Senior Chief of Operations

Subject: Bond Accountability Committee Membership

Background

The 2012 General Obligation Bond ballot measure and explanatory statement language was referred to the Multnomah Elections Division on August 21, 2012. The measure's summary statement identified the requirement for PPS to provide citizen accountability and oversight. With the passage of the 2012 Capital Construction Bond, staff developed a Bond Accountability Committee (BAC) charter with Board input to address this requirement. As noted in the charter, the BAC consists of approximately 7 - 10 individuals with a good reputation in the community for fairness and transparency and people with a combination of experience in building design; construction; construction financing; public contracting, budgeting and/or auditing.

The BAC has 3 vacancies. These vacancies occurred mid 2024 when 3 committee members withdrew from serving on the BAC due to new employment conflicts. In October, PPS initiated a public recruitment process to fill these open positions. After engaging with several highly qualified candidates, the Real Estate Infrastructure and School Enhancements (RISE) Office recommends the following individuals for appointments to the Bond Accountability Committee:

Brian Harper
Brian brings more than two decades of expertise in procurement, contract management, and pre-development, with a strong track record of ensuring transparent, accountable, and community-informed processes. Much of this experience comes from work in the public sector which gives him specific knowledge in the work the committee oversees.

Kelly Wingard
Kelly is a seasoned engineering leader with deep expertise in managing large-scale federal infrastructure projects, bringing years of experience in project delivery, regulatory compliance, and complex stakeholder coordination. Her background spans public-sector project management, federal procurement, and industrial engineering, giving her a strong foundation in both technical execution and oversight of multimillion-dollar programs.

Chris Poulsen
For the past 30+ years Chris has been involved with and led the investigation, design, procurement and construction of private and public projects involving environmental site remediation, storm and wastewater treatment, and associated facilities.

Staff Recommendation

Staff recommend the appointment of Brian Harper, Kelly Wingard, and Chris Poulsen to the

committee for the following term durations:[1]

- Brian Harper, 2-year term expiring December 2027
- Kelly Wingard, 2-year term expiring December 2027
- Chris Poulsen, 2-year term expiring December 2027

Resources

- Bond Accountability Committee Charter: https://www.pps.net/Page/464

[1] Committee memberships are filling the remaining 2 years of the 3 year term vacancies.